

STAGE FIFTEEN • BUSINESS & ORGANIZATIONAL ACUMEN

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Fifteen • Business & Organizational Acumen

PURPOSE

Stage Fifteen's group activities are mostly verbal and analytical rather than physical, which means most adapt to video reasonably well. The genuine exceptions are activities involving visual comparison of real documents (the Panel Comparison for Competitive Analysis) and the deliberately adversarial Devil's Advocate Round, where tone is harder to read on video and needs an explicit reminder that the pushback is a structured exercise, not real disagreement.

This document covers every activity across Stage Fifteen's Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that genuinely changes shape between formats.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Explain It to a Stranger / small-group icebreakers	Small clusters of chairs, genuine back-and-forth conversation.	Breakout rooms of 2-3, 4-5 minutes. Post the prompt in chat before sending people in, since there's no facilitator physically circulating to clarify.
Cross-Team Interview Swap (FIRST S3, from Group Versions doc)	Pairs turn to face each other; easy to gauge genuine surprise or correction in real time.	Breakout rooms of 2. Works naturally well online since it's just a structured conversation — no materials needed.
Blind Spot Swap (FIRST S10)	Physical lists exchanged hand to hand.	Use a shared doc (one tab per person) rather than screen-sharing sequentially — lets both partners edit and add simultaneously.
Devil's Advocate Round (FIRST S13)	Pairs face each other; tone and genuine pushback are easier to calibrate live.	Breakout rooms of 2. Explicitly remind pairs that the pushback is a deliberate exercise, not genuine disagreement — tone is harder to read on video and could otherwise feel more adversarial than intended.
Recommendation Pitch (FIRST S16)	Delivered standing or facing a partner directly; timing enforced with a visible clock or timer.	Breakout rooms of 2, with the 60-second limit stated clearly in the instructions since there's no visible room-wide clock.
Panel Comparison (FIRST S18)	Small groups cluster around printed or laptop-displayed matrices.	Share matrices via a collaborative doc or shared screen in a breakout room rather than describing them verbally, since visual comparison is the actual point of this exercise.
Role-Swap Panel (FIRST S21)	Small groups of 3-4 seated together; natural back-and-forth questioning.	Breakout rooms of 3-4. This genuinely works well online since it's primarily verbal; ensure cameras are on so the “panel” dynamic feels real rather than like a one-way presentation.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use “raise hand” or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For any activity involving a shared document or visual comparison (Blind Spot Swap, Panel Comparison), give in-person and remote participants the same digital artifact to work from — don't let in-person pairs use paper while remote pairs use a shared doc, since the two versions can drift out of sync.

For the Devil's Advocate Round specifically, a hybrid pairing (one in-person, one remote) should be avoided if possible — the deliberately challenging tone is easier to calibrate correctly when both participants share the same medium.